- The person has shaking chills or his temperature is over 101°F (38.3° C).
- The person has skin that is red or sore. These may be areas where the skin is broken down or getting infected.
- You have questions or concerns about the person's injury/illness or medicine.
- Seek care immediately if:
- The person has trouble breathing all of a sudden.
- The person has signs of a heart attack
- Chest pain or pressure that spreads to your arms, jaw, or back. Nausea (sick to your stomach), Trouble breathing, Sweating.

8.6 Pressure Ulcer

8.6.1 Definition

Pressure ulcers, also known as **pressure sores, pressure injuries, bedsores,** and **decubitus ulcers**, are localized damage to the skin and/or underlying tissue that usually occur over a bony prominence as a result of pressure, or pressure in combination with shear and/or friction.

The most common sites are the skin overlying the sacrum, coccyx, heels or the hips, but other sites such as the elbows, knees, ankles, back of shoulders, or the back of the cranium can be affected.



8.6.2 Causes

Pressure ulcers occur due to pressure applied to soft tissue resulting incompletely or partially obstructed blood flow to the soft tissue. Shear is also a cause, as it can pull on blood vessels that feed the skin. Pressure ulcers most commonly develop in individuals who are not moving about, such as those being bedridden or confined to a wheelchair.

There are four mechanisms that contribute to pressure ulcer development:

External (interface) pressure applied over an area of the body, especially over the bony prominences can result in obstruction of the blood capillaries, which deprives tissues of oxygen and nutrients, causing ischemia (deficiency of blood in a particular area), hypoxia (inadequate amount of oxygen available to the cells), edema, possible onset of osteomyelitis, inflammation, and, finally necrosis and ulcer formation. Ulcers due to external

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